

So, this day, 17th August 2017 sadly happens to be my last day as a child. Why? It's not like I'll stop breathing at the stroke of midnight; neither like we're awaiting a meteor to initiate a deadly apocalypse tonight; well, it's just that, tomorrow, by some myriad coincidence, is my 18th birthday. Wow!

And by the virtue of the fact which is widely accepted all around – that the moment you are eighteen you become an adult; I shall have to force myself with a mental note of NOT being a child anymore.

But, the question to the exceedingly witty intellectuals who developed this system would be – how can you claim with such absolute certainty that eighteen is the exact frail line which distinguishes our childhood from adulthood? Or rather do you mean to say that at the stroke of midnight on our 18th birthday our childhood is in chronological equilibrium with our adulthood?

But well, jokes apart. But honestly, I can hardly tell how it is with other people, but tagging me as an adult, I believe, would barely refrain me from being childish; and the vice versa. So, the idea of having a benchmark is nothing but sheer bullshit.

But what deserve a room for thought are the changes which will anyways be there; even if they are sternly unwelcome.

Firstly, I'll be jailed in a normal prison if out of genuine instincts I murder my ex. Secondly, I'll have to choose among a bunch of assholes to represent me at the Parliament. Thirdly, I can choose to end my life by consuming alcohol and banging my own vehicle into a tree. Fourthly, 'youtube' will no longer bar me from watching naked people involved in bliss. And lastly, and most importantly, I'll be at my own liberty to conduct such bliss myself. Hell yeah!

And obviously there are many more to the list. Yet, it keeps ticking in my head about how the actual differences would be – not the formal ones!

So, I just switch to my Super-thoughtful mode and launch a mental quest to figure them out.

Guess what? I find just one – ‘Responsibility’; not in a way how I’m responsible for breaking my neighbor’s window panes; neither like it’s my responsibility to keep the water bottles filled to their neck when mom is not at home, and blah blah.

Well, I realized that this time it is going to be different.

It’s actually like the feeling would always keep ringing in my head that even the rice I am stuffing myself with is earned by someone else. And it’s time that I take up that ‘responsibility myself.

Now, let me make you aware of this marvelous made up equation;  $\text{wealth} \leq \text{tension}$ , and i leave it to your own cool interpretation. But, our childhood is free from any tension of this kind, because the wealth part is non-existent. And so far our recurring worries would just whirl around things like whether she would reply the texts; whether sir would catch us eating in the backbenches; whether the principal would trace the porn folders in my pen drive; whether the structure of DDT would be asked in the exam; or whether my personal diary would end in my dad’s hands etc. Now I can wish to have all these worries with a warm smile, and NOT burden my shoulders with the necessity to earn.

But, and but, my dear Childhood,

I know, now, no matter how much I try to, I cannot get you back. And, from the deepest corner of my heart I can plead that I don’t want you to go.

And yet on those fine mornings, when I’ll sit by the balcony and all of you, together, would flash before my eyes; creating a gigantic lump in my throat, and a bigger void in my heart; about how I had hidden dad’s shoes to keep him from office; how I had spent that three hour train journey with a unknown girl admiring the little bridges whenever they came; how I had thrown the stranger’s bag at the mela being dared by friends and had been fiercely chased; how we had broken into marriages,

uninvited, and subsequently, got caught; how I had laughed and cried with my best friend, both without reasons; how illegally our previous birthdays were celebrated; and how i had wept beneath the pillow, through the night, following the so called break-up; and so on.

And trust me; these would be the reminiscences over which I'll build my next.

And i believe, in some faded gray canvas, the child i am leaving behind would keep wandering about these little moments.

And I'm grateful for these wonderful memoirs; which, no matter wherever or whenever or however they come, will make me well up with a wry smile.

I love you, dear childhood.

And, I'll miss you a lot.

Farewell!